

as the camera comes with a dedicated button. All you need to do is connect the camera to the PC using the USB interface and press the button—the application automatically gets launched.

The camera cannot directly save images in the TIFF format and the images may get patchy, especially when there are gradual variations in tone and colour. Distant photographs using maximum zoom showed a slight pixelation. The bundled software, Canto Cumulus 5.0, is used to transfer images from the camera as well as for basic image editing. The installation was hassle free and the camera was detected instantly.

**Price:** Rs 29,000  
**Contact:** Antrix Tech Zone  
**Phone:** 022-8061531  
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## SWiSH 2.0

### Flash it around

SWiSH 2.0 is the quick, easy, and affordable way to create Flash animations for your Web site. You can create animated effects, shapes, text, buttons, sprites, motion paths, and your own dazzling effects or make an interactive movie by adding actions to objects. SWiSH has 150 ready-to-use animated effects such as Explode, Vortex, 3D Spin, and Wave. SWiSH exports the same SWF file format used by Macromedia Flash, so almost all Web surfers can see your animation without having to download a plugin.

One problem you might face with this software is its inability to export your work in GIF format. The other feature it lacks is image compatibility; SWiSH is only good for its intended pur-

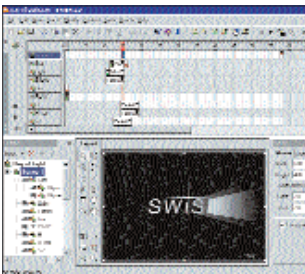
**Price:** Rs 2,450 (approx)  
**Web site:** www.swishzone.com

The lightweight and rechargeable Lithium-Ion battery makes it easy to carry the camera around for outdoor photography. The different modes in which the images can be captured assure good quality pictures, both indoors and outdoors. This camera is well suited for the enthusiast and amateur photographer. But professionals will have to look at other high-end cameras with at least a 4-Megapixel CCD.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

2.14-Megapixel CCD, 8 MB Compact Flash memory, USB interface

| Nikon COOLPIX 775 |            | B+ |
|-------------------|------------|----|
| Performance       | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Build Quality     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for Money   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features          | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL           | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |



pose, which is basically text animation.

This version includes Movie, Scene, Transform and Action tabs that were not available in earlier versions. SWiSH 2.0 delivers a 'kindergarten' level text 'fx' solution for Flash wannabes.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

4.55 MB file size, compatible with SWF file format of Macromedia

| SWiSH 2.0       |            | A- |
|-----------------|------------|----|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Ease of use     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for Money | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL         | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |

## EyeD OptiMouse

### Security at your fingertips

This optical mouse has one very unique feature. It has a fingerprint recognition system integrated into it. This USB mouse, when attached to your system, scans the finger you use to operate the mouse with and then creates a user account. The bundled software can even be configured to scan more than one finger. This is an important feature because if your finger is hurt, the mouse will not allow you to access the system. It is therefore advisable to have at least two accounts (two fingerprints) per machine.

The design of the mouse is not very impressive and the scroll wheel isn't smooth. The mouse was not directly detected and you need to attach an older PS/2 or serial mouse along with it to load the driver. The bundled software gives you an option to feed in all the fingerprints from either hand, but the best thing to do here is to have the impression of a colleague or another fam-

**Price:** Rs 13,900  
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ily member so that the machine would not be inaccessible if you're not around. Conversely, if security is paramount, there is no way another user would be able to access the system. This mouse is a great buy for users who are satisfied with adequate functionality as a pointing device, but need additional security for the critical information stored on their computer.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

USB interface, optical pointing mechanism, programmable button, finger print recognition

| EyeD OptiMouse  |            | B+ |
|-----------------|------------|----|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Build Quality   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for Money | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL         | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |

## Nike PSA[Play 120

### Just play it

This MP3 player sports a radical design and is created for people on the move. Targeted specifically at sportspersons, this digital audio player can be strapped onto your arm with the included arm-band and offers an hour of MP3 digital audio encoded at 128 Kbps. The main unit is completely moulded in a rubber coating, making it resistant to moisture and heat. This makes the player

well suited for strenuous applications such as jogging, exercising, etc. The player's 64 MB of memory can be expanded to 128 MB through the Smart-Media memory interface.

Controls for Play, Forward, Volume, etc are located on the base unit. It's linked to an in-line volume controller that also features the LCD display, which shows information about the track and the mode that the player is operating in. The headphones,

